# 2021 年 12 月大学英语六级考试真题(第 3 套)

## Part I Writing (30 minutes)

**Directions:** *For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to write an essay related to the short passage given below. In your essay, you are to comment on the phenomenon described in the passage and suggest measures to address the issue. You should write at least **150** words but no more than **200** words.*

Some parents in China are overprotective of their children. They plan everything for their children, make all the decisions for them, and do not allow them to explore on their own in case they make mistakes or get hurt.

## Part II Listening Comprehension (30 minutes)

说明：由于 2021 年 12 月六级考试全国共考了两套听力，本套真题听力与前两套内容相同，只是选项顺序不同，因此在本套真题中不再重复出现。

## Part III Reading Comprehension (40 minutes)

### Section A

说明：由于 2021 年 12 月六级考试全国共考了两套选词填空，本套真题选词填空与前两套内容相同，因此在本套真题中不再重复出现。

### Section B

**Directions:** *In this section, you are going to read a passage with ten statements attached to it. Each statement contains information given in one of the paragraphs. Identify the paragraph from which the information is derived. You may choose a paragraph more than once. Each paragraph is marked with a letter. Answer the question by marking the corresponding letter on **Answer Sheet 2**.*

**Why facts don't change our minds**

A) The economist J. K. Galbraith once wrote, "Faced with a choice between changing one's mind and proving there is no need to do so, almost everyone gets busy with the proof."

B) Leo Tolstoy was even bolder. "The most difficult subjects can be explained to the most slow-witted man if he has not formed any idea of them already; but the simplest thing cannot be made clear to the most intelligent man if he is firmly persuaded that he knows already, without a shadow of doubt, what is laid before him."

C) What's going on here? Why don't facts change our minds? And why would someone continue to believe a false or inaccurate idea anyway? How do such behaviors serve us? Humans need a reasonably accurate view of the world in order to survive. If your model of reality is wildly different

from the actual world, then you struggle to take effective actions each day. However, truth and accuracy are not the only things that matter to the human mind. Humans also seem to have a deep desire to belong.

D) In *Atomic Habits*, I wrote, "Humans are herd animals. We want to fit in, to bond with others, and to earn the respect and approval of our peers. Such inclinations are essential to our survival. For most of our evolutionary history, our ancestors lived in tribes. Becoming separated from the tribe—or worse, being cast out—was a death sentence."

E) Understanding the truth of a situation is important, but so is remaining part of a tribe. While these two desires often work well together, they occasionally come into conflict. In many circumstances, social connection is actually more helpful to your daily life than understanding the truth of a particular fact or idea. The Harvard psychologist Steven Pinker put it this way, "People are embraced or condemned according to their beliefs, so one function of the mind may be to hold beliefs that bring the belief-holder the greatest number of allies, protectors, or *disciples* (信徒), rather than beliefs that are most likely to be true."

F) We don't always believe things because they are correct. Sometimes we believe things because they make us look good to the people we care about. I thought Kevin Simler put it well when he wrote, "If a brain anticipates that it will be rewarded for adopting a particular belief, it's perfectly happy to do so, and doesn't much care where the reward comes from—whether it's *pragmatic* (实用主义的) better outcomes resulting from better decisions., social (better treatment from one's peers., or some mix of the two."

G) False beliefs can be useful in a social sense even if they are not useful in a factual sense. For lack of a better phrase, we might call this approach "factually false, but socially accurate." When we have to choose between the two, people often select friends and family over facts. This insight not only explains why we might hold our tongue at a dinner party or look the other way when our parents say something offensive, but also reveals a better way to change the minds of others.

H) Convincing someone to change their mind is really the process of convincing them to change their tribe. If they abandon their beliefs, they run the risk of losing social ties. You can't expect someone to change their mind if you take away their community too. You have to give them somewhere to go. Nobody wants their worldview torn apart if loneliness is the outcome.

I) The way to change people's minds is to become friends with them, to integrate them into your tribe, to bring them into your circle. Now, they can change their beliefs without the risk of being abandoned socially.

J) Perhaps it is not difference, but distance, that breeds tribalism and hostility. As proximity increases, so does understanding. I am reminded of Abraham Lincoln's quote, "I don't like that man. I must get to know him better."

K) Facts don't change our minds. Friendship does. Years ago, Ben Casnocha mentioned an idea to me that I haven't been able to shake: The people who are most likely to change our minds are the ones we agree with on 98 percent of topics. If someone you know, like, and trust believes a radical idea, you are more likely to give it merit, weight, or consideration. You already agree with them in most areas of life. Maybe you should change your mind on this one too. But if someone wildly different than you proposes the same radical idea, well, it's easy to dismiss them as nuts.

L) One way to visualize this distinction is by mapping belies on a spectrum. If you divide this spectrum into 10 units and you find yourself at Position 7, then there is little sense in trying to convince someone at Position 1. The gap is too wide. When you're at Position 7, your time is better spent

connecting with people who are at Positions 6 and 8, gradually pulling them in your direction.

M) The most heated arguments often occur between people on opposite ends of the spectrum, but the most frequent learning occurs from people who are nearby. The closer you are to someone, the more likely it becomes that the one or two beliefs you don't share will bleed over into your own mind and shape your thinking. The further away an idea is from your current position, the more likely you are to reject it outright. When it comes to changing people's minds, it is very difficult to jump from one side to another. You can't jump down the spectrum. You have to slide down it.

N) Any idea that is sufficiently different from your current worldview will feel threatening. And the best place to ponder a threatening idea is in a non-threatening environment. As a result, books are often a better vehicle, for transforming beliefs than conversations or debates. In conversation, people have to carefully consider their status and appearance. They want to save face and avoid looking stupid. When confronted with an uncomfortable set of facts, the tendency is often to double down on their current position rather than publicly admit to being wrong. Books resolve this tension. With a book, the conversation takes place inside someone's head and without the risk of being judged by others, It's easier to be open-minded when you aren't feeling defensive.

O) There is another reason bad ideas continue to live on, which is that people continue to talk about them. Silence is death for any idea. An idea that is never spoken or written down dies with the person who conceived it. Ideas can only be remembered when they are repeated. They can only be believed when they are repeated, I have already pointed out that people repeat ideas to signal they are part of the same social group. But here's a crucial point most people miss: People also repeat bad ideas when they complain about them. Before you can criticize an idea, you have to reference that idea. You end up repeating the ideas you're hoping people will forget—but, of course, people can't forget them because you keep talking about them. The more you repeat a bad idea, the more likely people are to believe it.

P) Let's call this phenomenon Clear's Law of Recurrence: The number of people who believe an idea is directly proportional to the number of times it has been repeated during the last year—even if the idea is false.

36. According to the author, humans can hardly survive if separated from their community.
37. People often accept false beliefs because they prioritize social bonds rather than facts.
38. Most often people learn from those close to them.
39. Sometimes people adopt certain beliefs in order to leave a favorable impression on those dear to them.
40. Compared with face-to-face communication, books often provide a better medium for changing people's beliefs.
41. On many occasions in daily life, people benefit more from their social bonds than from knowing the truth.
42. If you want to change somebody's beliefs, you should first establish social connection with them.
43. Humans cannot survive without a fair knowledge of the actual world.
44. Repetition of bad ideas increases their chances of being accepted.
45. Nobody is willing to give up their beliefs at the risk of getting isolated.

## Section C

**Directions:** *There are 2 passages in this section. Each passage is followed by some questions or*

*unfinished statements. For each of them there are four choices marked A), B), C) and D). You should decide on the best choice and mark the corresponding letter on* ***Answer Sheet 2*** *with a single line through the centre.*

**Passage One**

**Questions 46 to 50 are based on the following passage.**

The subject of automation and its role in our economy has taken hold in American public discourse. Technology broadly and automation specifically are dramatically reshaping the way we work. And we need to have a plan for what's still to come.

We don't have to look further than our own communities to see the devastating impact of automation. From automated warehouses to cashierless grocery stores to neighborhood libraries that offer self-checkout lanes instead of employing real people—automation is increasingly replacing jobs and leaving too few good new jobs behind.

The statistics in manufacturing are staggering. Despite the widespread fears about trade, a recent report showed that just 13 percent of jobs lost in manufacturing are due to trade—the rest of the losses have been due to advances in technology.

That is why more people are criticizing the ever-increasing role of technology in our economy. Our country is manufacturing more than ever before, but we are doing it with fewer workers. However, it's not just factories that are seeing losses-software and information technology are also having a dramatic impact on jobs most people think are secure from the forces of a rapidly-changing economy. Something transformative is happening in America that is having an adverse effect on American families. Whether policymakers and politicians admit it or not, workers have made clear their feelings. about their economic insecurity and desire to keep good jobs in America.

So why are people so insistent on ignoring the perils of automation? They are failing to look ahead at a time when planning for the future is more important than ever. Resisting automation is futile: it is as inevitable as industrialization was before it. I sincerely hope that those who assert that automation will make us more effective and pave the way for new occupations are right, but the reality of automation's detrimental effects on workers makes me skeptical. No one can currently say where the new jobs are coming from or when, and any sensible company or country should prepare for all alternatives.

I'm not overstating the danger: look at what's happened to the labor force. According to economic research, one in six working-age men, 25-54, doesn't have a job. Fifty years ago, nearly 100 percent of men that age were working. Women's labor force participation, meanwhile, has slipped back to the level it was at in the late 1980s.

American families and prominent business leaders are aware that there's a big problem with automation. The value of a college degree is diminishing, and our upward mobility is declining. If we want an economy that allows everyone to be economically secure, we need to start thinking about how we can rightfully address automation.

46. What can we observe from the author's description of our communities?

A. The growing passion for automation.
B. The shift from manual jobs to IT ones.
C. Their changing views on employment.
D. Their fading employment opportunities.

47. What do we learn from a recent report?

A. The manufacturing sector is declining at a fast rate.
B. The concerns about the effect of trade are exaggerated.
C. The fears about trade have been spreading far and wide.

D. The impact of trade on employment has been staggering.

48. What does the passage tell us about American workers in an era of transformation?

A. They feel ignored by politicians.
B. They feel increasingly vulnerable.
C. They keep adapting to the changes.
D. They keep complaining but to no avail.

49. What does the author think of automation?

A. It will have the same impact as industrialization.
B. It provides sensible companies with alternatives.
C. Its alleged positive effects are doubtful.
D. Its detrimental effects are unavoidable.

50. What should we attach importance to when dealing with automation?

A. College graduates' job prospects.
B. Women's access to employment.
C. People's economic security.
D. People's social mobility.

**Passage Two**

**Questions 51 to 55 are based on the following passage.**

Look at the people around you. Some are passive, others more aggressive. Some work best alone, others crave companionship. We easily recognize that there is great variation among the individuals who live near us. Yet, when we speak of people from elsewhere, we seem to inevitably characterize them based on their country of origin.

Statistics specialists, when they speak of national averages, often make the same mistake.

Newly published research shows how erroneous such overviews are. Three researchers analyzed decades of values-based surveys and found that only between 16% and 21% of the variation in cultural values could be explained by differences between countries. In other words, the vast majority of what makes us culturally distinct from one another has nothing to do with our homeland.

To determine what factors really are associated with culture, the authors combined data from 558 prior surveys that each measured one more of Hofstede's cultural dimensions. These are traits, such as individualism and masculinity, that describe work-related cultural values. (They are not a measure of visible cultural traits, such as food or dress.) Though the validity of Hofstede's dimensions has been questioned, they have the singular benefit of having been in use for decades, which allows for historical and international comparisons.

The researchers found that both demographic factors, such as age, and environmental factors, such as long-term unemployment rates, were more correlated with cultural values than nationality. Occupation and social economic status were the most strongly correlated, suggesting that our values are more economically driven than we usually give them credit for.

The evidence implies that people with similar jobs and incomes are more culturally alike, regardless of where they live. Vas Taras, the lead author of the study, puts it this way: "Tell me how much you make and I will make a pretty accurate prediction about your cultural values. Tell me what your nationality is and I probably will make a wrong prediction."

Taras says our erroneous belief that countries are cultures has caused businesses to teach their employees useless or even harmful ways of interacting with their international peers. Chinese and American lawyers might be trained to interact based on the assumption that the Chinese person is less individualistic, even though their similar social economic situations make it probable they are actually quite alike in that regard.

The country, as the unit of authority, is often a convenient way of generalizing about a population. However, our focus on countries can mask broad variations within them. In the majority of cases we

would be better off identifying people by the factors that constrain their lives, like income, rather than by the lines surrounding them on a map.

51. What error do experts often make when describing people from other places?
    A. They tend to overly rely on nationality.
    B. They often exaggerate their differences.
    C. They often misunderstand their cultures.
    D. They end to dwell on national averages.
52. What do we learn about Hofstede's cultural dimensions?
    A. They are useful in comparing cultural values across time and space.
    B. They have brought unusual benefits to people of different cultures.
    C. They are widely used to identify people's individual traits.
    D. They provide valuable questions for researchers to study.
53. What did researchers find about previous studies on factors determining people's value?
    A. Environmental factors were prioritized over other factors.
    B. An individual's financial status was often underestimated.
    C. Too much emphasis had been placed on one's occupation.
    D. The impact of social progress on one's values was ignored.
54. What is the impact on employees when cultures are identified with countries?
    A. They may fail to see the cultural biases of their business partners.
    B. They may fail to attach sufficient importance to cultural diversity.
    C. They may not be taught how to properly interact with overseas partners.
    D. They may not be able to learn the legal procedures for business transactions.
55. What does the author suggest at the end of the passage?
    A. There is sufficient reason to generalize about a country's population.
    B. The majority of people are still constrained by their national identity.
    C. It is arguable that the country should be regarded as the unit of authority.
    D. Nationality is less useful than socio-economic status as an indicator of one's values.

## Part IV Translation (30 minutes)

**Directions:** *For this part, you are allowed 30 minutes to translate a passage from Chinese into English. You should write your answer on* ***Answer Sheet 2****.*

井冈山地处湖南、江西两省交界处，因其辉煌的革命历史被誉为“中国革命红色摇篮”。1927年10月，毛泽东、朱德等老一辈革命家率领中国工农红军来到这里，开展了艰苦卓绝的斗争，创建了第一个农村革命根据地，点燃了中国革命的星星之火，开辟了“农村包围（besiege）城市，武装夺取政权” 这一具有中国特色的革命道路，中国革命从这里迈向胜利。井冈山现有100多处革命旧址，成为一个“没有围墙的革命历史博物馆”，是爱国主义和革命传统教育的重要基地。

# KEYS

## Part I Writing

**Suggested Version**

Nowadays, the one-child policy has triggered a controversial issue as to Chinese parents over-protecting their children. Some believe that parents can never put too much emphasis on planning and preparing things for their children while others argue that this is extremely harmful for these youngsters. Such phenomenon can be attributed to the following factors.

First and foremost, the strict one-child policy in the past three decades has brought the issue that couples cherish their only child and endeavor to prepare thoroughly for them. Planning everything and making every decision in advance, these parents fear that their children might make mistakes or get hurt. What's more, youngsters are likely to depend on their parents both mentally and financially. I am a case in point. It is not exaggerated to say that my parents are the persons I trust in most.

As far as I am concerned, parents should be aware that overprotecting will only do harm to their children. In addition, youngsters should think independently and rely on their own when it comes to making decisions. Moreover, society should help spread the dangers of indulging children. Only by doing so can we make family education in a balanced way.

## Part II Listening Comprehension

OMITTED

## Part III Reading Comprehension

| **26** | **27** | **28** | **29** | **30** | **31** | **32** | **33** | **34** | **35** |
|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|---|
| OMITTED | | | | | | | | | |
| **36** | **37** | **38** | **39** | **40** | **41** | **42** | **43** | **44** | **45** |
| D | G | M | F | N | E | I | C | O | H |
| **46** | **47** | **48** | **49** | **50** | **51** | **52** | **53** | **54** | **55** |
| D | B | B | C | C | A | A | B | C | D |

## Part IV Translation

Jinggangshan, located at the boundary between Hunan and Jiangxi Province, is well known as "the birth place of Chinese revolution", due to its glorious revolutionary history. In October, 1927, the old revolutionists including Mao Zedong and Zhu De, led the Chinese labor workers and peasant army here to launch the arduous struggle. It was also in Jinggangshan that they fought to establish the first rural revolution base, ignite the sparks of Chinese revolution, and paved a revolutionary way with Chinese characteristics to "besiege the cities with the countryside and seize the central power with military force." It is right from here that the Chinese revolution has marched towards its eventual success. With over 100 revolutionary sites, Jinggangshan itself has become a museum of the Chinese revolutionary history and an important base for patriotism and education of traditions stemmed from the revolution.